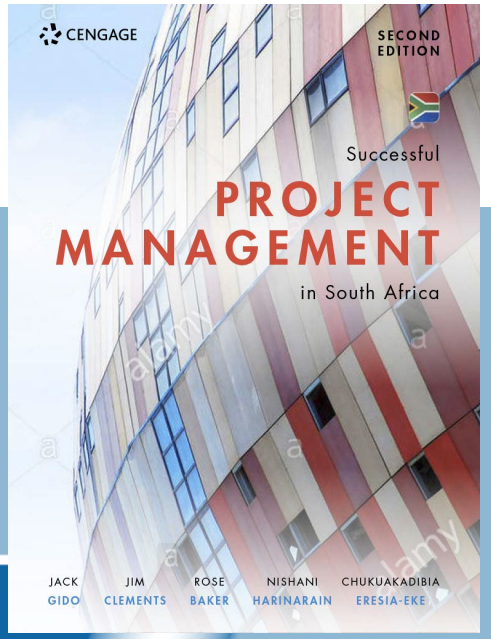
Learning Unit 5

Project Management Information Systems



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Appendix Concepts

- Discussions of:
  - The common features available in most PMISs
  - Advantages of using a PMIS
  - Concerns of using a PMIS
  - How to find vendors offering PMISs

- Criteria for selecting a PMIS

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Project Management Information System Features

- Budgeting and Cost Management
- Communications
- Documentation Management
- Integration and Customisation
- Online Tutorials
- Project Planning
- Project Portfolio Management
- Project Tracking and Control
- Report Generation
- Resource Management
- Risk Management
- Sales and Business Development
- Security and Access Controls

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Criteria for Selecting Project Management Information Systems

- Capacity
- Documentation and online help facilities
- Ease of use
- Features available
- Installation requirements
- Integration with other systems
- Internet features
- Reporting capabilities
- Security
- Vendor support

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Advantages of Using Project Management Information Systems

- Ability to handle complexity on large-scale projects
- Accuracy
- Affordability
- Ease of use
- Maintainability and modifiability
- Record keeping
- Speed
- What-if analysis

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Concerns about Using Project Management Information Systems

- Distraction
- False sense of security
- Information overload
- Learning curve
- Overreliance on information system

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Project Management Information Systems Vendors

- Numerous systems are available
  - Provide support for project management process
  - Provide online demonstrations or free trials
- Evaluations of top selling systems online
  - Comparison of popular systems
  - Lists of features
  - Summary of strengths and weaknesses

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Examples of Project Management Information Systems

1. **Microsoft Project**: Microsoft Project is one of the most popular project management software tools. It allows users to create schedules, allocate resources, track progress, and manage budgets.
2. **Oracle Primavera**: Oracle Primavera is a comprehensive suite of project management tools designed for large and complex projects. It includes features for planning, scheduling, risk management, and collaboration.
3. **JIRA**: JIRA is a project management tool developed by Atlassian, primarily used for software development projects. It facilitates agile project management methodologies such as Scrum and Kanban and includes features for issue tracking, task management, and team collaboration.
4. **Trello**: Trello is a lightweight project management tool that uses a card-based system to organize tasks and projects. It is known for its simplicity and ease of use, making it popular among small teams and individuals.
5. **Asana**: Asana is a collaborative work management platform that allows teams to organize tasks, track progress, and communicate effectively. It includes features for project planning, task assignment, and team collaboration.

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Examples of Project Management Information Systems continued…

6. Basecamp: Basecamp is a project management and team collaboration tool that focuses on simplicity and ease of use. It includes features for task management, file sharing, and team communication.

7. Smartsheet: Smartsheet is a cloud-based platform for project management and collaboration. It combines the functionality of spreadsheets with project management features, allowing users to track tasks, manage resources, and visualize project data.

8. Wrike: Wrike is a project management software that offers features for task management, team collaboration, and project reporting. It is known for its flexibility and scalability, making it suitable for teams of all sizes.

9. Teamwork: Teamwork is a project management and collaboration platform that includes features for task management, time tracking, and project planning. It is designed to help teams streamline their workflows and improve productivity.

10. Monday.com: Monday.com is a visual project management tool that allows teams to plan, track, and collaborate on projects in real-time. It includes customizable boards, timelines, and automations to streamline project workflows

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Summary

- Project management information systems include a number of features . The most common are budgeting and cost management, communications, documentation management, integration and customisation, portfolio management, online tutorials, project planning, project tracking and control, report generation, resource management, risk management, sales and business development, and security and access controls.
- Criteria for selecting a project management information system include capacity, documentation and online help facilities, ease of use, features available, integration with other systems, installation requirements, reporting capabilities, Internet features, security, and vendor support.
- The benefits of project management information systems include accuracy, affordability, ease of use, ability to handle complexity, maintainability and modifiability, record keeping, speed, and what-if analysis.
- The concerns about project management information systems include becoming distracted by the project management information system, a false sense of security, information overload, the learning curve, and overreliance on the project management information system.

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MS Projects Activity

Instructions:

- **Open** *MS Project*.
- **Apply the steps** as set out in the **Appendix** titled **'Microsoft Project'** in **Chapter 4** of the textbook and **build** a project entitled **'Consumer Market Study Project'**. Make sure you do the following:

1. Start a **new** project;
2. Set the project properties;
3. Enter the anticipated project **start date**;
4. Enter **work packages** and **activities**;
5. Enter **predecessor data**;
6. Create a **network diagram**;
7. **Assign** resources;
8. Setting a **baseline**.

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